

MIGRATION DEFERRAL RECORD -- LEGACY VESSEL PARTICULARS AMENDMENT SCREEN

Document	CHD-IS-2023-009
Date	November 7, 2023
Prepared by	S. Quill, Information Systems Administrator
Reviewed by	R. Calloway, Harbormaster
Subject	Deferral of migration of the legacy vessel particulars amendment screen (module VP-03), including change request CR-0412

1. BACKGROUND

1.1 The vessel particulars amendment screen (VP-03) is a component of the 1998 HarborMaster Billing & Registry System. It is the only counter screen that logs transactions to a workstation identifier (HB-COUNTER-2) rather than to the individual user. Change request CR-0412, opened 2021, requested user-identifier logging; the 2021 systems plan proposed folding CR-0412 into a full migration of VP-03 to the current platform.

1.2 Migration was scoped in 2022: move the particulars register to the current schema, re-key the 1998 screen's function in the supported interface, and retrofit user-identifier logging. Scoping produced an estimate of \$96,000 for migration and \$38,400 for the logging retrofit alone, plus regression testing of the billing interface that consumes the register.

2. DEFERRAL DECISION

2.1 At its meeting of 7 November 2023 the Information Systems steering group (Harbormaster, Finance Manager, IS Administrator) decided to defer the migration to no earlier than fiscal 2027 and to carry CR-0412 as an unfunded change request in the interim. The decision rests on three findings:

1. The 2024 budget cannot absorb \$96,000 without displacing the Salmonberry float replacement, which is grant-funded on a fixed construction window.
2. The compensating control adopted with Resolution 2022-06 section 5.4 -- the Deputy Harbormaster's monthly review of the register against the counter day logs -- has operated since August 2022 without a missed month.
3. The register's documentation exposure is addressed at the file level by Resolution 2022-06 section 4.3, which requires the certificate or haul-out record to be on file regardless of who keyed the row.

2.2 The deferral is recorded in the change request log: CR-0412 status DEFERRED, target release blank, funding source none, with a note that the request remains open since 2021.

3. DEFERRAL CONDITIONS

1. The monthly supervisory review continues without interruption; a missed review month escalates CR-0412 to the steering group within 30 days.
2. The register export is archived quarterly so that any later investigation works from a fixed copy.

3. No enhancement work is performed on VP-03 other than emergency repair, to avoid destabilizing the legacy build.
4. The deferral is reviewed at each annual budget and upon any audit finding touching amendment attribution.

3-A. OPTIONS CONSIDERED

3-A.1 Option 1 -- logging retrofit only (\$38,400). Modify the 1998 screen module to write the logged-in user to each register row. Cheapest path to attribution; leaves the rest of the 1998 module untouched. Risk: the legacy build has no test environment; a regression in the amendment screen reaches the billing interface, and a billing fault during the month-end run is the District's worst routine systems outcome.

3-A.2 Option 2 -- full migration (\$96,000). Re-key the particulars register into the supported schema, retire VP-03, and deliver logging as a by-product. The steering group's preferred end-state; unaffordable in the deferral window without displacing the Salmonberry float replacement.

3-A.3 Option 3 -- wrapper screen (\$14,900, quoted 2023-02). A modern front-end that writes through to the legacy register and keeps its own user-keyed log. Rejected: the wrapper's log would not be the register of record, and the District would then maintain two amendment records that an auditor could legitimately ask to reconcile.

3-A.4 The steering group chose Option 4 -- defer with compensating controls (the monthly review, the quarterly archive, and the file-level documentation standard of Resolution 2022-06 section 4.3) -- and to revisit at the 2027 budget.

3-B. VENDOR CORRESPONDENCE

3-B.1 The original vendor's successor firm confirmed by letter dated 2023-08-22 that the 1998 build is out of support, that source for the screen module is held in escrow and buildable only with the 2003 toolchain, and that their quotation for the logging retrofit assumes four weeks of contractor time including regression of the billing interface. The letter is held in the IS correspondence file.

3-B.2 The District's counsel reviewed the escrow arrangement in 2022 and confirmed the District may engage any competent contractor; there is no exclusivity barrier. The constraint is budget and risk, not access to source.

3-C. REGRESSION SCOPE IF FUNDED

3-C.1 The regression package for CR-0412, scoped in 2023 and kept current, covers: amendment entry for all 18 register fields; reversal rows; the billing interface's consumption of amended lengths in foot-month calculations; the offer module's use of amended particulars in match tests; month-end and year-end runs; and the quarterly archive export. Estimated at 11 contractor days in addition to the build.

4. RISK ASSESSMENT

4.1 Residual risk: attribution of any of the register's amendment rows to an individual clerk requires the handwritten day logs; where a day log page is illegible, attribution fails. The likelihood of a material dispute turning on clerk identity is assessed as low; the consequence, where it occurs, is that the District relies on the paper support rather than the keying clerk -- which is the position the documentation standard

already takes.

4.2 The risk is accepted for the deferral period. The state performance audit (fieldwork from 2025-01-01) has been advised of the deferral and of the compensating control; the deferral record will remain in effect through the audit window.

5. REVIEW HISTORY

Reviewed at the 2024 budget (October 2024): deferral continued, estimate unchanged. Reviewed at the 2025 mid-year systems review (June 2025): deferral continued; CR-0412 remains open and unfunded. Next scheduled review: 2027 budget, with delivery of user-identifier logging targeted in that cycle.

6. REVIEW RECORD (MINUTES EXTRACTS)

6.1 October 2024 (2025 budget session). The steering group reviewed the deferral against the 2024 register statistics (1,977 amendment rows at that date), noted that the monthly supervisory review had run 26 consecutive months without a miss, and continued the deferral. The Salmonberry float replacement's grant window was the stated budget constraint. Quill minuted a dissent of one: his recommendation was to fund the \$38,400 retrofit from the systems reserve; the group preferred to hold the reserve against the NAS replacement and the commission chambers AV refresh.

6.2 June 2025 (mid-year systems review). The group reviewed the deferral in light of the state audit then in fieldwork. The audit liaison confirmed the audit team had been given this deferral record and the configuration report, and had asked no follow-up question about the deferral itself. The group continued the deferral and added the quarterly-archive label requirement (the archive label now carries the source-document cross-reference count as well as the row count).

6.3 Interim check, January 2026. No missed review months in 2025; 46 register rows remain in day-log gaps per the liaison's reconstruction; no applicant dispute in the window turned on clerk identity. The risk acceptance stands. The 2027 budget package will carry CR-0412 as a funded item with the option-1 retrofit as the delivery approach.

7. SUCCESS CRITERIA AND EXIT FROM DEFERRAL

7.1 The deferral ends when the retrofit or migration is delivered and verified. Verification means: a register row written by the new build carries the logged-in user identifier; the register export shows the user field populated from go-live; the billing interface regression passes on the contractor's certificate and the District's month-end run; and the quarterly archive resumes with the enriched row layout.

7.2 Historical rows will not be backfilled: pre-go-live rows continue to carry the workstation identifier only, and this deferral record remains the standing explanation of that fact. The District's auditors in any future engagement should be handed this record on day one.

Reviewed by: Reuben Calloway, Harbormaster